IELTS ACADEMIC · STUDENT WORKSHEET

IELTS Academic Set 23

All sections

Name: _____ Date: _____

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Work through each IELTS part in order. Reading passages stay with their questions; charts and diagrams appear next to their tasks. Open the live practice page for Listening audio and Speaking recordings.

Staff solutions and scripts are supplied separately.

Listening

Use the separately supplied audio. Write one response for each question.

IELTS Academic Listening Practice - Set 23

Original unofficial practice material aligned to the public IELTS Academic Listening format. It is not an official IELTS test.

You will hear four recordings. You will hear each recording once only. Answer Questions 1-40 as you listen. At the end, you will have 2 minutes to check your answers.

Spelling must be correct. Follow the word and number limit shown for each completion task.

Part 1 - Community-theatre costume hire

A performer speaks to a wardrobe assistant.

Questions 1-6

Complete the form below. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

1. Production: _____

2. Role played: _____

3. Main costume item: _____

4. Waist measurement: _____ cm

5. Fitting date: _____

6. Fitting time: _____

Questions 7-10

Complete the sentences below. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

7. The deposit is released after a _____.

8. The hired boots must be kept _____.

9. The borrowed hat should be carried in its _____.

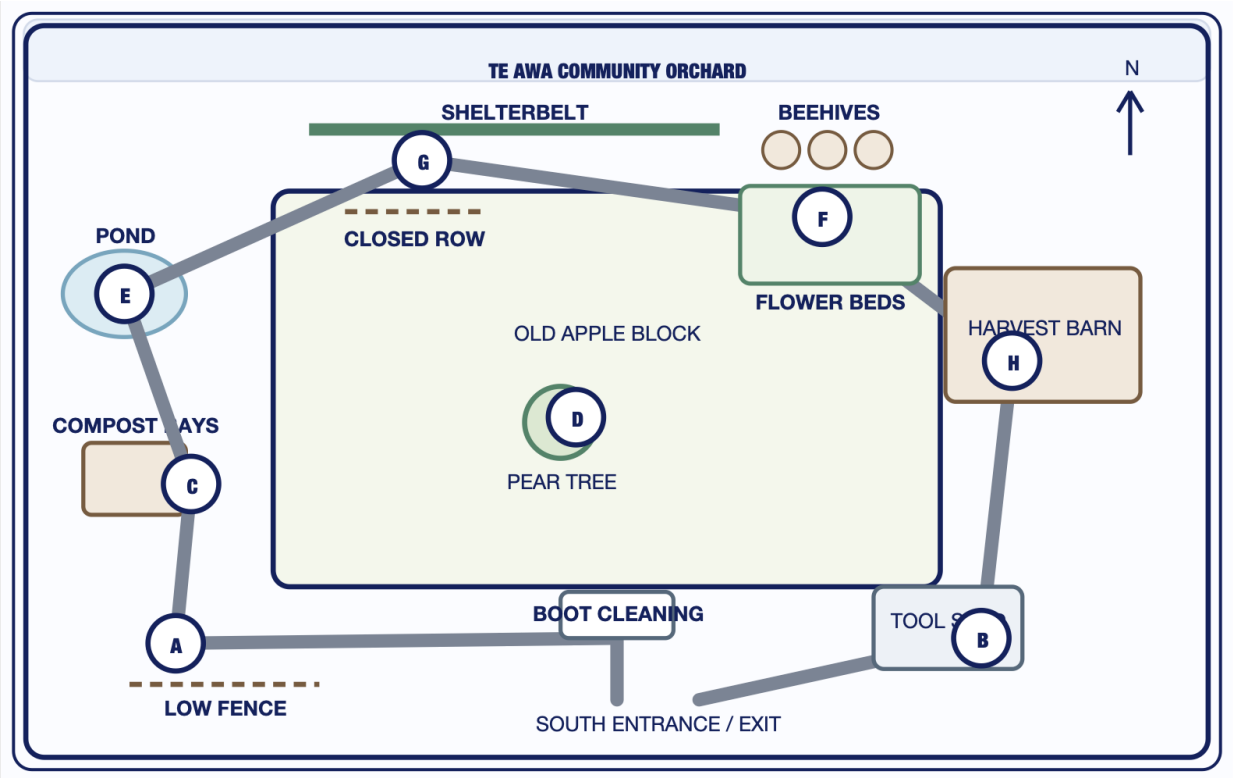
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10. If the return will be late, Carys must contact the _____.

Part 2 - Te Awa Community Orchard open day

An organiser explains a route and activity locations.

Te Awa Community Orchard - open-day route



Questions 11-16

Label the map below. Choose the correct letter, A-H, for Questions 11-16.

11. Welcome gazebo

12. Grafting tent

13. Children's discovery trail

14. Pollinator garden

15. Harvest table

16. Tool-return point

Questions 17-20

Which location will host each activity? Choose A-E for Questions 17-20. You may use any letter more than once.

A	orchard classroom
B	packing shed
C	south lawn
D	compost yard

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E	picnic terrace

17. cider-pressing demonstration

18. soil-health clinic

19. surplus-fruit exchange

20. mulch-making workshop

Part 3 - Wave-energy tank test

Two engineering students and their supervisor revise a testing plan.

Questions 21-25

Choose the correct answer, A, B or C.

21. What do the students identify as the most likely cause of the inconsistent force readings?

A The wave paddle was programmed at the wrong height.

B A bracket holding the force sensor became loose.

C The model absorbed water during the later runs.

22. Why do they decide to keep the existing model for the next session?

A It lets them isolate the measurement problem.

B A replacement would take too long to paint.

C Its scale matches a published experiment.

23. What change will they make to the order of the test conditions?

A Run the highest waves first.

B Group conditions by wave period.

C Use a randomised sequence.

24. What will be the main purpose of the overhead video?

A To measure the model's maximum displacement.

B To check the timing of impact events.

C To replace the readings from one wave gauge.

25. What result will show that the short pilot has succeeded?

A The model returns to exactly the same position.

B The force signal remains below the design limit.

C Two wave gauges record a consistent phase relationship.

Questions 26-30

Who will be responsible for each task? Choose A, B or C for Questions 26-30. You may use any letter more than once.

A	Nia Patel
B	Owain Brooks
C	Harriet Cole

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26. recalibrate the force sensor

27. rewrite the randomisation schedule

28. approve the revised risk assessment

29. check the camera timestamps

30. request the wave-paddle logs

Part 4 - Desert varnish formation

A lecturer reviews evidence and competing explanations.

Questions 31-36

Complete the sentences below. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

31. Desert varnish is found as a thin coating on exposed rock _____.

32. Much of its mineral material arrives as airborne _____.

33. The darkest varnish contains a high concentration of _____.

34. One formation hypothesis gives an important role to _____.

35. The coating is typically less than half a _____ thick.

36. In the cited comparison, the underlying rock was _____.

Questions 37-40

Answer the questions below. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

37. What kind of analysis had rarely been applied to desert varnish?

38. Which experiment revealed differences between varnish and its substrate?

39. Which mineral was described as familiar in magnetic studies?

40. Which planet makes possible biological explanations especially interesting?

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Reading

Read the three passages and answer Questions 1-40. Enter or select each answer on screen. The IELTS Academic Reading test allows 60 minutes, including checking time.

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A Beam with a Signature

A Lighthouse illumination must satisfy two requirements: producing light and directing enough of it towards a distant mariner. A source inside a lantern sends rays in many directions, so only a portion travels towards the horizon. Increasing brightness can improve visibility, but undirected output still leaves much of the energy elsewhere. The keeper therefore faces linked tasks: maintaining the source and shaping its output. The optical challenge is to collect rays that would otherwise scatter and redirect them into a concentrated beam. A source can supply light, yet useful range depends on how effectively an apparatus controls where that light travels.

B Early lighthouse lenses offered one answer, but conventional glass became thick and heavy when made large enough for a powerful station. Light was lost inside the material. In 1811, the French Commission on Lighthouses created a committee to investigate better illumination. Augustin Fresnel completed a flashing-lens design in 1822. Instead of requiring one enormous solid lens, the design divided the optical work among thinner pieces. This reduced unnecessary glass while preserving the curved action needed to bend light. The proposal mattered because it joined a solution to an optical purpose: more of the lamp's output could leave the tower as a useful beam.

C The profile resembles a beehive assembled around the source. At its centre, a bull's-eye section bends rays passing through it. Above and below, concentric prisms intercept rays that travel too steeply upward or downward and redirect them towards the horizon. Each surface changes the path of light by refraction, reflection, or a combination for its position. Because the optical power is distributed across these sections, the apparatus can have a collecting area without the bulk of a solid lens. The result is concentration rather than creation: no light appears, but more travels in the direction where a navigator can see it.

D A revolving installation combines optics, structure and motion. The lamp remains at the optical centre while the lens surrounds it. A flash panel contains elements that form a strong directional beam; several panels may be arranged around the lamp. The assembly rests on a roller carriage so that it can turn with little friction while keeping alignment. A lower clockwork unit supplies controlled motion. Its gearing is linked to a suspended drive weight, whose gradual descent stores and releases energy needed for rotation. The keeper raises the weight, much as a clock is wound. Operation depends on their relationship: centred illumination, correctly oriented glass and steady movement.

E Rotation transforms a directional beam into a timed signal. When a panel faces an observer, a flash is seen; darkness follows as the lens turns away. The number of panels and rotational speed determine how often flashes return. Gears regulate the interval, while the support prevents irregular movement from distorting it. A station could display a sequence of light and dark periods rather than a merely bright light. Automation replaced repeated winding but did not alter the underlying logic. Whether raised by hand or powered otherwise, the mechanism must carry the optical assembly past the viewing direction at the expected moment.

F The timed sequence became the light's characteristic. Mariners did not need every lighthouse to produce the same pattern; difference was useful. A chart or light list recorded a station's colour and its intervals of brightness and darkness. By observing a pattern and comparing it with that record, a crew could identify the station and relate the vessel's position to the coast. A beam extended the distance at which this identification was possible. Thus the rotating lens supported navigation in two ways: it concentrated illumination, and it organised that illumination into information. The darkness between flashes was part of the message, not simply an interruption.

G Fresnel lenses were classified into orders according to size and optical scale. Large first-order apparatus served seacoasts, while smaller fifth- or sixth-order examples suited rivers and bays where the required range was shorter. The choice therefore followed the station's setting rather than a rule that larger was always better under the conditions then available. Many lenses were later removed or replaced by modern lights, yet examples survive in working towers and museums. An installation makes visible a chain of engineering decisions: thin optical elements reduce weight, a supporting

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frame keeps them aligned, rotation creates a signal, and the signal lets observers identify a place.

Questions 1-6

Label the diagram. Complete each label with NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the passage.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Questions 7-13

Which paragraph contains the following information? Select the correct letter, A-G, for each question. You may use any letter more than once.

1	A
2	B
3	C
4	D
5	E
6	F
7	G

7. an explanation of why the interval without light contributes to identification

8. the official investigation that preceded a major optical design

9. evidence that the appropriate apparatus size depended on location

10. a reason why producing light did not by itself solve the early problem

11. a later technological change that left the basic operating principle intact

12. how thinner pieces solved a structural problem while preserving optical action

13. two distinct navigational benefits produced by the rotating system

Listening to the Body: What Exactly Is Measured?

A Interoception is the processing of signals that arise within the body. Such signals matter to accounts of emotion because bodily change and the interpretation of context jointly contribute to how a feeling is experienced. Yet research becomes misleading when every interoceptive measure is treated as the same ability. Accuracy concerns whether a person can detect or discriminate an internal event correctly. Attention concerns whether that event currently occupies awareness. A third construct, belief about accuracy, records what people think about their own performance. Someone may notice a heartbeat often but judge it poorly, or detect it accurately in a task without attending to it during ordinary life. The labels describe related questions, not interchangeable scores.

B Heartbeat tasks illustrate the difficulty. In a counting task, participants report beats during a period without taking a pulse. The result can look like direct perception, but prior beliefs about normal heart rate and skill in estimating time may influence the count. Discrimination tasks instead ask whether an external cue is simultaneous with a heartbeat, testing a narrower

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judgement under conditions. Neither task reveals how frequently cardiac sensations attract attention outside the laboratory. Moreover, performance for one signal cannot be extended to hunger, respiration or temperature. A method is therefore informative only after its target has been specified: objective detection, self-reported belief, or the momentary allocation of attention.

C To examine attention in daily life, one study used experience sampling rather than a single laboratory session. The participants were 107 adults. Smartphone messages arrived ten times a day for either five or seven days, with at least thirty minutes between prompts. At each daily survey, participants reported whether they had been attending to any of 21 signals. They also reported current fatigue, tension and emotional valence. As an external comparison, the survey asked about auditory attention. Repeated prompts created thousands of observations, allowing the researchers to separate differences between people from changes occurring within the same person across situations.

D Internal signals captured attention in about one fifth of the observations, whereas sounds were attended to in eighty-three per cent. This contrast does not show that auditory perception was more accurate; the survey recorded whether attention was engaged. Nor was the internal category uniform. Thirst was noticed more often than heartbeat or rapid breathing, and the amount of variation across occasions differed among signals. Crucially, forty-four per cent of the variance in state interoceptive attention occurred within individuals. A person who seemed highly attentive on one occasion might be less so later. A single score can therefore conceal fluctuations associated with activity, temperature, food, social context or other changing circumstances.

E The repeated reports also permitted comparison with mood at the same moment. Greater state interoceptive attention was associated with more negative valence and greater fatigue, but not with tension in the same pattern. The finding does not mean that noticing the body necessarily causes unpleasant feeling. A difficult experience might draw attention inward, an internal signal might influence mood, or both might respond to another condition. Because measurement was concurrent, causal direction remains unresolved. The result nevertheless challenges the assumption that more attention is always beneficial. Missing an important signal may be unhelpful, but constant monitoring may not be desirable either. The useful level probably depends on which signal is present and why it matters.

F Trait questionnaires added another distinction. A person's trait attention report was related to state attention measured across prompts, situations and days. By contrast, belief in interoceptive accuracy was not related to those state reports in the same way. This difference should not be converted into a claim that accuracy is irrelevant to emotion. The questionnaire measured beliefs about accuracy, not objective performance, and earlier laboratory work has linked behavioural accuracy measures with emotional experience. The cautious conclusion is structural: attention, objective accuracy and confidence about accuracy may contribute differently. Combining them into one total would erase information that could explain why two people with similar bodily sensitivity describe different emotional lives.

G Several limits shape interpretation. The sample was largely young, white and based in the United Kingdom, so the numerical rates need not represent every population. Momentary attention was self-reported, and the design observed association rather than experimentally changing attention. Even so, repeated measurement offers an advantage over a single visit because it exposes within-person movement over time that a one-off average cannot show. Future studies can add behavioural tasks, physiological recordings and more diverse samples, but they should preserve the distinction between constructs. They should also collect repeated observations with care if their question concerns a fluctuating state. Better measurement will not come from declaring one universal interoceptive score; it will come from matching the measure to the precise research claim.

Questions 14-20

Choose the correct answer, A, B, C or D, for each question.

14. What is the main distinction made in paragraph A?

A Related interoceptive measures can address distinct kinds of research question.

B The three measures tend to converge when bodily signals are strong.

C Beliefs about accuracy provide a practical substitute for task performance.

D Attention is most informative when it is measured in ordinary life.

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15. Why does the writer compare two heartbeat tasks?

A To explain why heartbeat counting is better suited to daily-life research.

B To show that cardiac tasks can be shaped by timing skills.

C To illustrate why a method must be linked to its intended target.

D To argue that cardiac tasks should be extended to hunger and temperature.

16. What was an advantage of the study design in paragraph C?

A It compared heartbeat accuracy with several other internal signals.

B It sampled participants many times in their everyday settings.

C It removed participants' daily context from the self-reports.

D It collected responses at fixed thirty-minute intervals.

17. What does the writer emphasise about the percentages in paragraph D?

A They compare how precisely sounds and internal signals were detected.

B They describe typical differences between younger and older participants.

C They suggest the internal signals attracted attention at broadly similar rates.

D They concern whether attention was engaged, not the quality of detection.

18. How does the writer interpret the mood finding?

A It complicates the claim that greater attention is necessarily more beneficial.

B It indicates that inward attention is the likely cause of negative mood.

C It places tension alongside fatigue as part of the same association.

D It suggests the association is independent of the internal signal involved.

19. What caution is made in paragraph F?

A Trait reports become comparable with state reports after both are averaged.

B Behavioural accuracy measures are less relevant than questionnaire measures.

C A state-attention score should include confidence about performance.

D A belief measure should not be treated as objective performance.

20. Which statement best expresses the conclusion of paragraph G?

A Repeated surveys can compensate for limited demographic diversity.

B Physiological recordings should replace momentary self-reports in later studies.

C Measures should be selected to fit the claim being tested.

D A broad score is useful when several interoceptive constructs are combined.

Questions 21-26

Complete each sentence with NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the passage.

21. Heartbeat counts may partly reflect a participant's skill in _____.

22. The repeated surveys asked about _____ rather than only one internal sensation.

23. The external comparison recorded by the surveys was _____.

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24. Greater momentary internal attention occurred with more fatigue and more _____.

25. Daily state reports were related to the general questionnaire measure of _____.

26. Research on changing states should gather _____ with care.

When a Sensor Is Designed to Vanish

A Some electronic sensors are useful only briefly. A device placed inside healing tissue may be difficult to retrieve without another operation; a sensor dispersed through a crop field may cost more to collect than to install. Transient electronics addresses such cases by designing circuits that function for a limited period and then disintegrate or dissolve. That distinction limits the claim. A short-lived device is not a universal answer to electronic waste, since many products can be repaired, reused or collected efficiently. Transience is strongest where retrieval itself creates risk, labour or environmental disturbance. Even there, a device must satisfy two separate tests: it must perform long enough, and what follows must be acceptably safe.

B The first test creates a timing problem. A pressure sensor that loses calibration during treatment has failed even if every component later disappears. Designers therefore need a defined service window: the period in which conductors, sensing layers, power sources and encapsulation maintain performance. Stability is not the enemy of transience; it is a requirement. The engineering task is to hold several degradation processes back until the work is complete, then allow them to proceed at a useful rate. Because different layers admit water, fracture or corrode differently, the failure of one component may end the device before the rest changes visibly. Claims about lifetime consequently require functional measurements, not merely photographs showing that an object remained present on an earlier day.

C Timing also depends on the trigger. Water can enter a protective layer and start hydrolysis; heat, light, acidity or biological activity may accelerate other reactions. A trigger suitable for one setting can be unreliable in another. Humidity, ions and sunlight vary by setting. Encapsulation can postpone contact with the trigger, but adding a barrier changes thickness, flexibility and the eventual residue. A designer must therefore match the trigger and protective structure to the intended environment rather than advertise a material's fastest reported decay. Control is especially difficult when storage, transport and use expose the device to similar conditions. Premature activation and indefinite persistence are opposite failures produced by the same poorly defined boundary.

D The second test begins when the device can no longer be seen. Physical disappearance is not chemical harmlessness. A film may break into fragments too small for the eye, while electrodes release metal ions or polymers leave persistent derivatives. Components that appear benign separately can also interact during degradation and form complexes absent from tests of the individual materials. Analysis of degradable sensors found that visual dissolution did not settle the identity or toxicity of the products remaining in solution. This changes the appropriate endpoint. Mass loss and photographs are useful observations, but neither proves that the surrounding medium has returned to its prior condition. Researchers need chemical identification, concentration data and toxicological evidence for the products, including those formed slowly after the visible structure has gone.

E Laboratory demonstrations can exaggerate certainty if their conditions are mistaken for the field. A small sample immersed in a warm, continuously mixed buffer experiences stable contact with a liquid of known acidity. A device in soil may alternate between wet and dry periods, encounter microbes, bind to minerals or sit in a cool layer with little oxygen. An implant faces another combination of enzymes, flow and tissue response. Faster disappearance in a chosen solution is evidence about that experiment, not a general calendar for every destination. Field trials are not superior; they introduce variation and make some products harder to recover for analysis. The stronger strategy connects controlled studies, which isolate mechanisms, with realistic exposures that test whether those mechanisms dominate outside the vessel.

F Language should reflect this evidence. Calling an entire sensor biodegradable because its substrate is cellulose ignores an electrode or conductive coating that may persist. Conversely, one durable part does not erase the value of a design if that part is intentionally recoverable after the other layers dissolve. Device-level assessment must record every component, the combinations created during manufacture and the expected route at end of life. Labels such as transient, degradable, biodegradable and sustainable answer different questions. Transient describes intended disappearance after stable operation; biodegradable refers to biological transformation under specified conditions; sustainable requires a wider account of sourcing, manufacture, lifetime and disposal. Treating these words as synonyms turns an engineering description into an unsupported environmental promise.

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G A credible evaluation can therefore be organised around four linked records. The function record defines performance and the service window. The environment record specifies the exposure that activates or delays change. The recovery record explains which residues, components or samples can be collected and what will remain beyond observation. Finally, the evidence record combines mass loss with chemical and biological tests, stating uncertainty and the duration of monitoring. No single result substitutes for the others. A device that vanishes safely but too early is useless in practical use; one that performs perfectly but leaves harmful products has merely hidden its cost. Transient electronics deserves neither automatic praise nor dismissal. Its value depends on matching a temporary need with controlled degradation and on following the material story far enough to show what disappearance actually means.

Questions 27-33

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list below. Select the correct Roman numeral, i-ix, for Questions 27-33. Use each heading only once.

i	Why disappearance is not a chemical conclusion
ii	Where avoiding retrieval creates a real advantage
iii	Applying environmental terms to the complete device
iv	A deadline for performance before change begins
v	The different contributions of controlled and realistic trials
vi	Four records for a defensible evaluation
vii	Selecting activation conditions for the destination
viii	Extending a fast laboratory result to a destination-wide schedule
ix	Judging a complete sensor by its biodegradable substrate

27. Paragraph A

28. Paragraph B

29. Paragraph C

30. Paragraph D

31. Paragraph E

32. Paragraph F

33. Paragraph G

Questions 34-40

Do the following statements agree with the views or claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3? Select YES if the statement agrees with the writer's view or claim, NO if it contradicts the writer's view or claim, or NOT GIVEN if the writer's view or claim is not stated.

34. The writer regards temporary devices as the best response to every kind of electronic waste.

35. A device may stop functioning before the rest of it changes visibly.

36. Humidity-triggered devices are cheaper to produce than devices activated by light.

37. Materials that appear harmless separately can form different products while degrading together.

38. Certification bodies require an outdoor soil trial for every transient sensor.

39. A durable component can be acceptable when it is deliberately recovered after other layers dissolve.

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40. Perfect performance does not compensate for harmful products left by the device.

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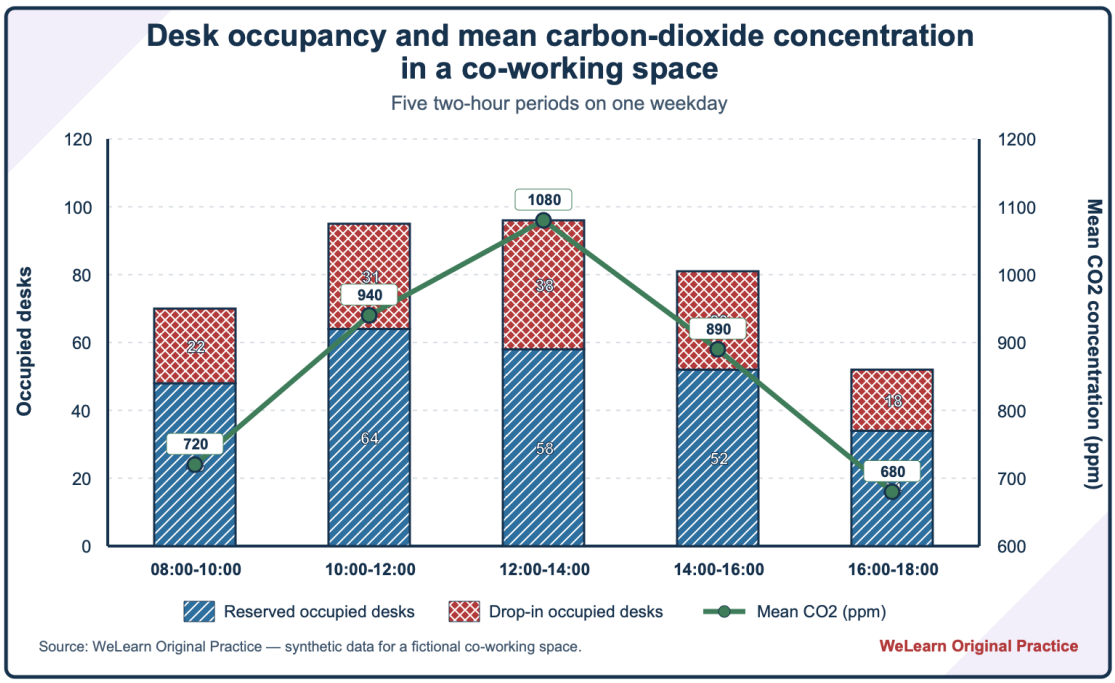
Writing

Writing Task 1

- You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.
- Write at least 150 words.

The chart below shows the number of occupied desks, divided into reserved and drop-in desks, and the mean carbon-dioxide (CO2) concentration in a fictional co-working space during five two-hour periods on one weekday.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Writing Task 2

- You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.
- Write at least 250 words.
- Task 2 contributes twice as much as Task 1 to the Writing score.

Some people think that research results produced by projects financed mainly with public funds should be freely available to everyone. In this question, the term research results refers to published findings and reports, not personal, confidential or security-sensitive data.

To what extent do you agree or disagree with this view?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

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Speaking

Part 1

Topic 1

Thank you. Now, in this first part, I'd like to ask you some questions about yourself. Let's talk about borrowing things.

- How often, if ever, do you borrow things from other people?
- What kinds of things, if any, are you willing to lend to other people?
- If you borrow something, how would you remember to return it on time?
- If you borrow things at all, have your habits changed over time?

Topic 2

Now let's talk about street names.

- If streets in your area have names, how much attention do you pay to them?
- If you notice a street name, do you ever think about what it means?
- How useful can street names be when people are trying to find an address?
- What do you think makes a good street name?

Topic 3

Let's move on to quiet places.

- Are there times when you want to be somewhere quiet?
- If you wanted some quiet, what might you choose to do?
- If you look for quiet, are you more likely to find it at home, somewhere outside, or neither?
- Do you think you will want more quiet time in the future, or not?

Part 2

- Now I'm going to give you a topic. I'd like you to talk about it for one to two minutes.

Describe a time when information or an experience led you to change an opinion.

You should say:

- what opinion you held before
- what information or experience made you reconsider it
- when you realised your opinion had changed

and explain how this change influenced something you thought or did later.

- Was changing it difficult?
- Has the change lasted?

Thank you. We will now move on to Part 3.

Part 3

We've been talking about changing an opinion after receiving new information. I'd now like to discuss how people and institutions respond to evidence more generally.

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- Why can it be difficult for a person to change an opinion after seeing new evidence?
- Are people more likely to reconsider an opinion in private or while discussing it with a group?
- What makes an information source seem trustworthy, and can those signs ever be misleading?
- What responsibilities do schools and news organisations have in helping people judge evidence?
- How can public debates allow open disagreement without giving unreliable claims too much attention?
- In the future, should important public decisions rely more on experts, public opinion or computer systems?

Thank you. That is the end of the speaking test.

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Objective answer sheets

Listening

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
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16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Reading

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Writing response paper

Task 1 - response page 1 of 2

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Task 1 - response page 2 of 2

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Task 2 - response page 1 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 2 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 3 of 3

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Speaking notes

Use notes only for the permitted preparation time.

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